

MOMENT OF THE YEAR



Chhetri and a customary gesture

Indian men's football team captain, Sunil Chhetri, secured victory with a decisive goal during the Intercontinental Cup match against Vanuatu. To share the joyous news of impending parenthood, he celebrated in front of his wife, the ball tucked warmly within his jersey — a customary gesture in football worldwide to announce such delightful moments to the fans.



Determination, Sheetal's forte

Armless archer Sheetal Devi made headlines in October when she shot her way to three medals at the Asian Para Games. The 16-year-old, who hails from Kishtwar, Jammu and Kashmir, was born with phocomelia, a disorder causing underdeveloped limbs. Without arms, she learned to use a bow and arrow using her feet and started training full-time in archery only two years ago. Videos of her mounting the bow and using her right foot and mouth to steady the equipment before shooting perfect 10s went viral. From celebrities to the political brass, praise flooded in for the resilience and talent of the young girl, who eventually went on to finish the year as the No. 1 archer in open compound. GETTY IMAGES



Kohli on Mt. 50

Virat Kohli moved clear of former teammate and India great Sachin Tendulkar with a record-breaking 50th one-day international century in the first ODI World Cup semifinal against New Zealand at the Wankhede Stadium in Mumbai, the home ground of Tendulkar. Kohli reached the landmark in trademark fashion, completing a brisk two despite battling cramps. Once the milestone was reached, Kohli leapt and then bowed down to Tendulkar, his childhood hero, and the maestro heartily applauded from the stands. Kohli's coronation was now complete. GETTY IMAGES



Neeraj nahi tho Jena hai na!

When Pakistan's Arshad Nadeem pulled out on the eve of the Asian Games javelin throw final due to injury, Neeraj Chopra's path to Asian Games gold seemed guaranteed. But when the controversy surrounding Neeraj's first throw overshadowed the competition, Kishore Kumar Jena stepped up by recording his personal best throw of 86.77 m, momentarily propelling himself to first place. Neeraj immediately embraced his countryman to celebrate his achievement. The Olympic champion eventually secured gold and Jena a well-deserved silver. 'Maza aa gaya ek dusre ko push kar rahe the [It was fun pushing each other]', Neeraj said later. In that embrace, one saw a snapshot of the Indian javelin's future. If Neeraj ever has an off day, Jena has got you covered! GETTY IMAGES



Controversy, and a sigh of relief for Jyothi Yarraji

Jyothi Yarraji secured the silver medal in the women's 100m hurdles at

the Hangzhou Asian Games amidst a backdrop of intense controversy and drama. Initially disqualified for a false start, Yarraji was subsequently allowed to take part pending a thorough post-race review.

The official exoneration was declared approximately half an hour after the conclusion of the race. Notably, the decision not only vindicated Yarraji but also elevated her from the bronze to the silver position. This adjustment stemmed from the disqualification of the Chinese athlete, who initially claimed the second-place finish, a status that was ultimately not reinstated. It was Yarraji's fourth fastest run of the year and the eighth time she ran under 13 seconds in 2023. GETTY IMAGES